

Vera P. A. Obonyo
P O Box 1021- 00517
Nairobi
Mobile: 0724-672850
Email: vera.obonyo@ksg.ac.ke

My passion is in using technology and innovative learning solutions to facilitate capacity building, knowledge sharing and peer learning. My experience in working across multiple sectors has enhanced my skills, competencies and capabilities in developing and delivering solutions in training, consultancy and research to address identified needs.

Strengths

- Extensive experience in design, development and delivery of programmes in eLearning, ICT and knowledge management
- Experience in curricular and content development
- Experience in leading consultancy assignments
- Experience in research assignments
- Ability to build and lead teams to deliver on targets
- Excellent organizational and coordination skills
- Excellent communication and presentation skills (i.e. both oral and written);
- Creative problem solver with good analytical skills
- Confident, articulate and professional speaker

Academic Background

University of Nairobi - Kenya

Faculty of Business and Management Science
Ph.D. candidate in Business Administration

Temple University – USA

Fox School of Business and Management
Master of Science: Management Information Systems, 2003

Moi University - Kenya

Faculty of Information Sciences
Bachelor of Science: Information Sciences, 1996

Work Experience

Kenya School of Government -eLearning & Development Institute (eLDi)

Deputy Director, October 2017 – to date;

Training Manager, October 2013 – October 2017;

Training Coordinator, February 2012 – September, 2013

I rose from Training Coordinator to Deputy Director where I am responsible for implementation of policies and programs of the School in learning and development. Specifically my duties include:

1. Supervise training, consultancy, research and advisory services in eLearning, ICT and knowledge management including development of curricular and training materials;
2. Manage resources in the training department;
3. Oversee development and implementation of the eLearning platforms;
4. Develop and recommend long term business strategies and plans;
5. Coordinate the development of new business proposals
6. Coordinate consultancy assignments
7. Develop and implement annual budgets, work plans and procurement plans to ensure provision of required resources for planned activities and control costs
8. Ensure quality and professionalism in conducting all training programs;
9. Facilitate courses offered in the School

Cellulant Kenya Ltd

Head of Process and Service Delivery, November 2008 – December 2011

The key responsibility was driving the operational functions through direct oversight of information systems, business processes and quality assurance.

- a. Quality Management
 - i. Provided leadership to the Quality Assurance team;
 - ii. Designed the monitoring and evaluation tools for client projects; and
 - iii. Developed documentation and process-flows of all operational and administrative procedures for customer service and product delivery.
- b. Leadership

Provided leadership to following technology teams:

 - i. The product design team consisting of system analysts, implementation engineer and business analysts in putting together the business case and technical specifications for products.
 - ii. Support team that was responsible for ensuring infrastructure is running optimally, customer implementations get completed on time and on budget;
- c. Product Development
 - i. Reviewed the business cases for potential areas;
 - ii. Coordinated product deliveries to the customers; and

- iii. Ultimate custodian of the product lifecycle.
- d. Administration
 - i. Provided administrative and logistical support for all departments;
 - ii. Participated in hiring, assigning and supervising staff.

UNICEF - Kenya Country Office: Orphans and Vulnerable Children Cash Transfer
Management Information Systems Coordinator, September 2006 – October 2008

- i. Provided technical support to the Easy Social Systems (ESS) software developers in customizing the software to meet the needs of the Kenyan programme.
- ii. Coordinated the capacity building by organizing and implementing training of personnel charged with data-gathering both at the headquarters and district level
- iii. Coordinated information management and exchange between the headquarters and the districts.
- iv. Supported the Children Officers at the Ministry, District Children's Officers and partner agencies to ensure efficient management databases.

Daystar University, School of Business and Economics

Adjunct Lecturer, September 2006 – 2012

Full time lecturer, September 2005 – August 2006

- i. Deliver lectures, seminars and tutorials.
- ii. Develop and implement new methods of teaching to reflect changes in research.
- iii. Assess students' coursework.
- iv. Set, mark and moderate examinations and assessments.
- v. Supervise students' research activities, including final year undergraduate and Masters projects
- vi. Involvement in committees and boards.
- vii. Contribute to professional conferences and seminars in your field of expertise.

Messianic Jewish Alliance of America (MJAA)

Database Administrator, Sept 2003 – July 2005

- i. Plan, design, install and monitor Catch Up Pledge Program (CUPP) database.
- ii. Software installation and maintenance, application of patches and monitoring system performance
- iii. Perform database back-up and recovery

African Regional Organization for Standardization (ARSO)

Information and Documentation Officer, September 1997– October 2000

- i. Managed the Information & Documentation Department which included the networks, website, archives and record management
- ii. Trained staff in regional African member states on setting up databases on standardization.
- iii. Developed end-users support material i.e. notes on electronic conferencing, on-line database searching and the latest developments in electronic communication technology.
- iv. Maintained the databases and the library, publication of newsletters and the quarterly magazine – ARSO journal.
- v. Charged with developing and preserving archives and management of records
- vi. Trained in-house staff on information databases, software applications

Selected Professional Achievements

Kenya School of Government-eLearning and Development Institute:

A. Training

- i. Coordinated and successfully facilitated and delivered courses in the Institute for over 13 years. This includes training needs analysis, development of curriculum, preparation of training content, delivery of programs, evaluation and review. These programs are offered in-person, via video conference, online and using a blended approach. Notable programs include Data Protection, Cyber Security, Data Analytics, Information Systems Security, Financial Management for World Bank Project Accountants, Electronic Records Management as well as sessions in Senior Management Course, Strategic Leadership Development and Diploma in Public Administration.
- ii. Coordinated the design and development of KSG Learning Management System (LMS) that hosts the online programs of the School. Fifteen programmes have been converted to online mode, with a total of over 10,000 participants having successfully completed their training. I have facilitated in many of the programs offered online.
- iii. Coordinated the design and development of KSG Public Service Knowledge Hub that hosts knowledge assets from the School and the wider Public Service.

B. Research

- i. 2024 -2025: Coordinated the first Baseline Survey on ICT Skills in the Public Service: which was a Collaborative Study by the Kenya School of Government, UNDP, and the Ministry of Information, Communications, and the Digital

Economy to Assess Digital Competencies and Capacity Gaps for Effective Service Delivery

- ii. 2023 – 2024: Coordinated and was the lead researcher in two studies: *Applications of Cyber Security Measures in State Corporates in Kenya* which led to a follow-up study on *Applications of Cyber Security Measures in State Corporates in Kenya*
- iii. 2019: Coordinated research on *Contribution to Knowledge Management Practices to Food Security in Kenya*, undertaken in partnership with Ministry of Agriculture and United States International University–Africa. This includes field research, symposium and conference presentations.

C. Consultancy

- i. 2023 – 2024: Led a consultancy assignment for Probation and After Care Services (PACS) to design, develop and deliver and blended induction program for over 900 new officers.
- ii. February 2023 – August 2023: Project Manager for a GIZ – Digital Technology Centre (GIZ-DTC) to purchase computers, accessories and software as well as digitise the Data Protection Program. Through this program the Institute received donations of computer, cameras and recording equipment for development of eLearning programs.
- iii. FY 2019/2020 – FY 2022/2023: Project Lead for two School-wide consultancy assignments offer Technical Assistance to the Federal Government of Somalia and the Puntland State of Somaliland to build capacity to offer training the civil service. This included developing and delivering curriculum, training programs, policy documents as well as an eLearning Centre with video conference facility, computer lab and e-books library
- iv. Project Lead for consultancies in knowledge management. This included development of knowledge management policy, framework, specifications for a knowledge management system, capacity building of officers and training of knowledge management champions. Clients include Energy and Petroleum Regulatory Authority (EPRA) and Nuclear Power Energy Authority (NuPEA), Uwezo Fund and National Authority for Campaign Against Drug Abuse (NACADA).

D. Contributions to Development of KSG Policy Documents

Coordinated development and implementation of: KSG ICT Policy, Knowledge Management Strategy, Knowledge Management Policy, Training of Trainers for Faculty on Knowledge Management.

Cellulant (Kenya) Limited

Managed the team of software and support engineers who installed the first mobile banking and money transfer platforms in over fifteen banks including Barclays Bank, Standard Chartered, Faulu, I&M, K-REP, Chase Bank among others. The payment solutions quickly extended to non-fintech organizations such as DSTv, Kenya Airways, water companies to ease payments by customers.

UNICEF and Ministry of Home Affairs

Set-up the first fully-functional Data Centre for the Orphans and Vulnerable Children-Cash Transfer (OVC-CT). It was the first government cash transfer program in Africa that used a local customized information system that could hold over two million records.

Short Courses

- i. *Special Capacity Building Programme on Leadership and National Transformation for Senior Civil Servants of Kenya*, 13 – 18 January 2025, National Centre for Corporate Governance, India
- ii. *Training of Trainers on Case Writing and Teaching*, 4 – 8 December, 2023, Kenya School of Government
- iii. *Strategic Communication and Media Management*, 8 – 12 April, 2019, Kenya School of Government
- iv. *Learning Strategy Facilitator Workshop*, 4 – 8, December, 2018, Kenya School of Government
- v. *Designing Effective Peer Learning Offerings*, 4 – 8 December, 2017, Kenya School of Government
- vi. *Strategic Leadership Development Programme, SLDP 123/2017*, 17 July 17 – 25 August 2017, Kenya School of Government
- vii. *The Art of Knowledge Capturing*: 30 January – 1 February 2017, Kenya School of Government
- viii. *Senior Management Course – SMC 259/2016*, 3– 27 May 2016, Kenya School of Government;
- ix. *Facilitating Online*, 6 July – 21 August 2015, University of Cape Town, Centre for Innovation and Learning Technology;
- x. *eLearning Course Production*, 3 - 7 September 2012, Kenya Global Development Learning Centre;
- xi. *Transformational Leadership for Women Empowerment*, 7 – 11 May 2012, Tanzania Global Learning Agency, Kenya Development Learning Centre and Skills Focus

Learning Management Systems

- i. Experience: with Moodle and Blackboard LMS
- ii. Software tools used: iSpring Free, Audacity, Adobe Suite

Publications

- Imende-Obonyo, V., Njihia, M., Iraki, X. N. (2024). User Readiness as a determinant for use of big data analytics: A case of state corporations in Kenya. The Electronic Journal of Information Systems in Developing Countries
- Imende-Obonyo, V., Njihia, M., Iraki, X. N (2023) Organisational Capabilities and Use of Big Data Analytics: A Grounded Theory Approach, Global Scientific Journal, Volume 11, Issue 9, p 176-195
- Boore, C., Mutiso, V. N., Obonyo V. (2021.) Use of ehealth and big data in management of Non Communicable Diseases in Developing Countries; the Kenyan Healthcare sector, IEEE-SEM, Volume 9, Issue 8, August-2021, pp 25-36
- Boore, C, Njihia, M., Iraki, X. N., Obonyo, V. (2020). E-health System Security Issues and Block Chain Technology in Kenya, IEEE-SEM, Volume 8, Issue 12, December-2020, p 1-8

Selected Presentations in Workshops and Conference

- Obonyo, V. & Karanja, N. Application of Cyber Security Measures in State Corporations in Kenya, Cyber Security Week Conference, September 26, 2024
- Obonyo, V. Nurturing Sufficient Technical Talent for Kenya, Kenya Fibre Data Summit 2023, AFRALTI, Nairobi, October 6, 2023
- Rumo, J. and Obonyo, V. Application of Knowledge Management Practices to Achiever Food Security and Nutrition in Kenya, Kenyatta University, Biennial Research and Innovation Conference, Nairobi, October 25, 2019
- Nyingi, S. & Obonyo, V. Blended Approach as an Alternative for Delivering Financial Management Programs for Health Workers, 10th eLearning Africa Conference, Cairo, May 23, 2015

Memberships

- Association of Information Systems (AIS), Membership No. 17959435
- Kenya Association of Public Administration & Management (KAPAM), No. 1399

Referees

Prof. Mike Kuria
Chief Executive Officer
Commission for University
Education
P O Box 54999-00200
Nairobi
Email: mikekuria@gmail.com
Mobile: 0735880917

Mr. Baraza Situma
Head of Digital Learning
Mastercard Foundation
Email: barazasituma@gmail.com
Mobile: 0728621593